Sarabhai was also a member of the National Planning Committee, an early version of the Planning Commission, where he argued for the importance of focusing on rural development. Sarabhai's children too played major roles in modern India. They included Vikram Sarabhai, the eminent scientist, and Mridula Sarabhai, the activist for social change.

In his autobiography, Gandhi records the incident that led to his long association with Sarabhai. Gandhi had started an ashram on the outskirts of Ahmedabad but donations had dried up because people didn't approve of 'untouchables' being accepted into the ashram. Just when all seemed lost, Sarabhai arrived and made a donation of 13,000 rupees (a substantial amount at the time), thus saving the ashram from closure.

KHWAJA ABDUL HAMIED

1898–1972



"IT IS NOT BRITAIN ALONE WHICH IS RULING OVER US, BUT THE INTELLECTUAL AND INDUSTRIAL SUPERIORITY OF THE WEST."